



FAWKNER MANSIONS

250 PUNT ROAD, PRAHRAN, VICTORIA · HERITAGE OVERLAY HO448

*A proposal for the research, digital preservation,
and public documentation of a heritage-listed
building — and what it can mean for the people
who own it.*

PREPARED BY DAVID HOUGH · SEPTEMBER 2026

1. THE OPPORTUNITY

Fawkner Mansions is, on the current heritage record, the oldest surviving residential flats in the City of Stonnington, and one of the oldest in Victoria.

Designed by Ernest H. Willis and built in 1910–11, the building has stood for 116 years with almost no public documentation beyond its council heritage citation (Heritage Overlay HO448). This proposal is an offer to change that — at no financial cost to the owners — in exchange for a modest, defined rent concession during the research period.

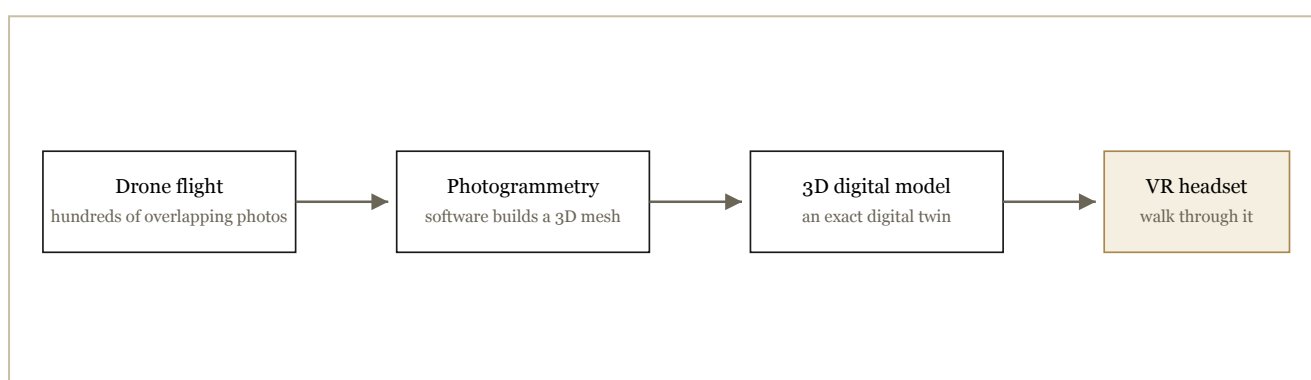
HERITAGE OVERLAY HO448	EDWARDIAN FREE CLASSICAL, 1910–11
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OLDEST SURVIVING FLATS, CITY OF STONNINGTON

2. THE VALUE I BRING

An evidence-trained researcher already living in the building is offering to do, essentially for free, work that would otherwise cost the owners real money to commission: professional-grade digital preservation, archival research, and a public-facing history — with an audit-style discipline applied to make sure every claim is sourced and defensible. On top of the core research and 3D/VR capture, I bring drone piloting and 3D mapping (photogrammetry) skills directly, plus documentary film-making, so the same capture work produces both the preservation record and a short history documentary at no extra cost.

What a drone-captured 3D model and VR record actually means



In plain terms: a drone photographs the building from hundreds of angles; software stitches those photos into an exact 3D digital replica; that replica can then be explored in **virtual reality** — putting on a headset (or using a web browser) and looking around as if physically standing inside or outside the building. If the building is ever altered or demolished, this record still exists, permanently, independent of the physical structure.

3. HOW THIS CREATES A LEGACY

This project turns Fawkner Mansions' rare heritage status into something permanent: a properly researched book, and a full digital VR record that heritage bodies, historians, and the public can reference indefinitely. Doing this now, while the building still stands largely intact, is a meaningfully time-sensitive opportunity. A well-produced documentary and a genuine "heritage building saved digitally" story is also a plausible media hook — local and potentially international press coverage that promotes the book, the documentary, and Fawkner Mansions itself simultaneously.

Beyond self-publishing, there is a real path to reach academic and publishing networks in Australia, Europe, the USA, and further afield — heritage and local-history titles are a genuine niche for university presses and specialist publishers, and university interest (see §6) makes a co-publishing or distribution conversation plausible, not just individual library sales.

4. WHY I'M SUITED TO DO IT

This isn't a hobbyist project. My background is in assurance and risk research — PwC Australia, Deloitte South Africa, Philip Morris International — plus a Master of Public Health that trained a systems-level, evidence-first way of thinking. I've built and run independent research systems (Sentrix Digital, RiskAtlas) and co-founded software companies (One1 Digital, PostNow, AfterDuty). I already live in the building, so access, motivation, and timeline all line up naturally.

Research discipline	Audit-trained evidence methodology — every historical claim sourced and traceable.
Technical capability	Drone piloting, photogrammetry, web development, documentary editing.
Academic grounding	Master of Public Health (Macquarie University); Bachelor of Business Systems (Bond University).
Track record	Founder/co-founder of multiple working systems and platforms, not a first attempt.

5. WHAT I WANT IN EXCHANGE

The ask	A defined research period (e.g. 3 months) in exchange for a rent discount or rent-free period.
The give	A professionally produced 3D/VR scan and digital record of the building, delivered regardless of whether the book is ever published, plus the heritage/publicity upside and a promotional documentary.
Owner risk	Low — deliverables are staged, with a checkpoint (e.g. 6 weeks) before the arrangement continues.
Owner cost	Defined and capped: the agreed rent concession only.
Fallback	If a rent concession isn't approved, a simple access/permission agreement with no rent change.

6. PUBLIC-INTEREST DISTRIBUTION POTENTIAL

Victoria has on the order of ~2,250 schools (government, Catholic, independent — approximate, for pitch purposes) and eight Victoria-headquartered universities, each with library budgets and relevant architecture/heritage departments. Because the trade edition is print-on-demand, these are standing, ongoing orders, not a one-off run. Draft German, French, Spanish, and Chinese editions extend this to international schools and diaspora/heritage audiences.

7. EXAMPLE POSTCARD TEMPLATES

A promotional/fundraising item, printable now or mailed directly to a recipient anywhere in the world via a future print-and-post integration:

FRONT	BACK
1960s photograph placeholder	Fawkner Mansions · 250 Punt Road, Prahran Edwardian Free Classical, 1910–11 · Heritage Overlay HO448

8. PAID GUEST WiFi — A SEPARATE VALUE-ADD

Not part of the book pitch, but worth raising at the same time: there is no free WiFi at the building today. A Starlink connection (~\$75/month) plus a captive-portal router — reusing the "Mansion WiFi" design already built — could offer paid guest access (\$5/day, \$20/week, \$50/month) via voucher tokens or card payment. Even light uptake clears the monthly connectivity cost.

Fawkner Mansions · 250 Punt Road, Prahran VIC 3181 · Heritage Overlay HO448

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